AGENTIC AI ZERO TO HERO · #2 · CHEAT SHEET

Generative AI vs AI Agents vs Agentic AI

github.com/pelthepu/agentic-ai-zero-to-hero

PROMPT-DRIVEN
Generative AI = Writer

DOES
Creates content from your prompt, then stops

TRIP
"Here's a 5-day plan for Tokyo, Mount Fuji and Kyoto"

CODE
"Write a function to validate an email" → a code snippet

EXAMPLES
Text, image, video and music models

TASK-DRIVEN
AI Agent = Skilled worker

DOES
Uses tools to finish one defined task

TRIP
"Find and book a Tokyo hotel under $150 a night"

CODE
"Implement and test email validation" → writes, runs tests, fixes

FLOW
Task → Tools → Action → Done

GOAL-DRIVEN
Agentic AI = Project manager

DOES
Owns the goal: plans, coordinates many tasks, adapts until done

TRIP
"Plan and manage my Japan trip" → flights, hotels, plan, weather, changes

CODE
"Deliver a reliable email-validation feature" → plan, build, test, deploy

FLOW
Goal → Plan → Act → Observe → Adapt → repeat

CAPABILITY (~ = partly)	GENAI	AI AGENT	AGENTIC AI
Answers questions	✓	✓	✓
Creates content	✓	~	~
Uses tools	~	✓	✓
Executes tasks	✗	✓	✓
Plans	✗	~	✓
Coordinates tasks	✗	~	✓
Adapts	✗	~	✓
Owns the goal	✗	✗	✓

THE ONE-QUESTION TEST

Does it **plan, decide and adapt** toward a goal with little human input? Yes: Agentic AI. No: it isn't.

SAME LLM, DIFFERENT SYSTEM

LLM + prompt	**Generative AI**
LLM + tools + fixed steps	**AI Agent**
LLM + tools + memory + planning + loop	**Agentic AI**

FOR DEVELOPERS

Anthropic (Dec 2024): a **workflow** runs LLMs and tools on code paths you wrote. An **agent** lets the LLM choose its own steps and tools. LLM + a fixed workflow is not Agentic AI. **Next:** lesson 3, your first agent in Python.


Pavan Elthepu
@pavanelthepu

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